

Day 4 — Sacred Groves

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify devarakāḍu and similar groves as biodiversity reserves.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *devarakāḍu* (IAST: devarakāḍu; lit. “sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Define sacred grove.** Patches of native forest preserved by community tradition, often associated with a deity, sage, or ancestor. Hunting, cutting, and even firewood collection are prohibited.
2. **Indian examples.**
 - *Devarakāḍu* (Karnataka)
 - *Kāvu* (Kerala)
 - *Devarakad* (Maharashtra)
 - *Sarna* (Jharkhand, Odisha, Bihar — tribal areas)
3. **Ecological function.** Despite covering <0.1% of India’s forest area, sacred groves preserve disproportionate biodiversity: endemic species, medicinal plants, water-table recharge zones. Madhav Gadgil’s research (1992 and onward) documented this.
4. **Source.** *Pr̥thivī Sūkta* (Atharva Veda 12.1) — particularly verses 11–13 on forests. Modern source: Gadgil & Guha, *This Fissured Land* (1992).
5. **Activity.** Each student researches one sacred grove (or biodiversity site) in their region and prepares a 1-page report. Map the grove, list flora/fauna, document traditional protection rules.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Sacred Groves.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).